MarsNavi

AIED 2026 Speaker Proposal — Supporting Materials

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> **Proposed Session:** When 10-Year-Olds Ship Real Products — What Two Years of Online AI-Native PBL Teach Us About Keeping Learning Human
> **Format:** Case study / classroom practice · **Strand:** Classroom Practice & Pedagogy

1 · The One Story That Frames Everything

On New Year's Eve 2025, Luo Zhenyu — host of the most-watched annual thought address in Chinese knowledge culture — devoted a segment of his broadcast to MarsNavi. He showed 34 short-video cover images produced by our 8–14-year-old students as the official visual preheat for a talk watched by **45 million+ online viewers** across 324 global satellite venues, and named our program as a live example of children learning AI through *real, delivered work*.

That moment is the visible tip of a two-year build. Underneath is something more unusual: an online, fully-instrumented PBL studio where every classroom minute is captured, every project is a real product with real users, and a purpose-built AI agent quietly does the work no human coach should have to do.

2 · Operational Snapshot

100+	20+	10M+	Aug 2024
children served (ages 8–14)	real AI products shipped	characters of verbatim transcript	MVP launch, still running

Cohorts operate primarily **online** (with periodic offline camps in Beijing, Tianjin, Shenzhen). Groups are capped at 6 students, each with a dedicated coach — not a subject teacher. Every session is transcribed via Feishu Minutes and ingested into a structured internal corpus for coach review and longitudinal analysis.

3 · Why Online PBL — And Why It Might Be Our Most Interesting Contribution

Project-based learning has historically failed to scale online. Coaching depth, artifact quality, and student accountability all tend to collapse over Zoom. Since 2024, MarsNavi has been building a working counter-example. The core design premises:

Feishu as the classroom substrate

Every online session runs inside Feishu, a collaboration platform with native meeting-transcription (Minutes). Every child's conversation, every coach intervention, every product iteration is captured verbatim and turned into structured records — without asking the coach to take notes.

An AI agent that removes coach overhead

We built a proprietary AI agent (internally: *Tongxing Bot*, our "coach companion") on top of the transcript layer. It does five things automatically for every online session:

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T − 2 days → agent notifies coach; helps set up parent WeChat group
T − 1 day 18:30 → agent pushes the pre-session support kit to the coach
During session → Feishu Minutes captures full verbatim transcript
T + 2 hours → agent nudges coach for the transcript link (once, never at
night)
T + 24 hours → agent auto-generates two documents:
      (a) Session Review — timeline, participation balance, coaching moves,
signals per student
      (b) Project Support Kit — what to prepare, what to ask, what to watch
for next time
Continuously → agent updates each child's longitudinal Feishu profile
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What this frees a coach to do

A MarsNavi coach's core operational responsibility is reduced, deliberately, to two verbs: **run the session** and **forward the transcript link**. Everything downstream — reflection, archival, profile updates, next-session prep — is agent work. The human coach spends their time on the humans in the room.

Why it matters for the summit's theme

"Keeping learning human" is often framed as a resistance to AI. Our operational answer is the opposite. AI, applied to the *administrative* layer of teaching (transcription, review, archival, prep), is precisely what makes room for coaches to be more human in the *interaction* layer. We will bring the actual documents, the actual agent output, and the actual coach workflow to the summit for discussion.

4 · Alignment With The Three Summit Criteria

Center the Learner

Every project topic is chosen by the children. Cohorts are capped at 6 to protect student voice. We have on-record: an 11-year-old spontaneously adding safety boundaries to his AI's system prompt (no violence, no doing school assignments for users); a 12-year-old

interviewing her older sister to research emotional needs for a job-search bot; a group of 8-year-olds dismissing their own AI's empathy as "*too cheesy*" in a live user test.

Use AI with Purpose

AI is never a demo in our program. It is the specific structural mechanism that lets a 10-year-old complete a real product cycle — problem definition, user research, prototype, real-user testing, iteration, public launch — inside a single online cohort. Our **Seven-Step Method** operationalizes this step by step: Consensus → Best-Practice Study → Product Design → MVP → Real-User Feedback → Mystery-NPC Expert Review → Public Launch. Our **L1–L5 progression** then scaffolds a child from first exposure through offline entrepreneurship.

Practice & Reflection

Two years. 100+ children. 20+ shipped products. 10M+ characters of transcript, structurally indexed. An operational AI agent producing over a hundred session reviews to date. We are prepared to walk the audience through the offline camps that didn't scale, the coaching interventions that broke a session, and three named coaching failure modes (over-coaching, under-coaching, emotional avoidance).

5 · Four Case Studies

Case A · Xiaoshu (age 11) — From "AI-as-cheating-tool" to Responsible Creator

Over one online L2 cohort, Xiaoshu shipped five distinct AI agents: a travel planner, a job-search coach, an NYE ticket concierge, a reading buddy, and a personal annual-retrospective site. Early on, he described AI as "*the cheat code for essays*" and rated his own AI-written essays as "*60-70% wrong.*" By the reading-buddy project, he was interviewing a real user with dyslexia (who had made it into NYU by listening to books) and had spontaneously written into his system prompt: *no violent content; do not complete school reading assignments on behalf of users.* A documented arc — on record, on transcript — of a child inventing product ethics from scratch. (Published on our public channel; source materials available on request.)

Case B · Hanyue (Online L3) — Real Users Change The Product

In the final sprint of an online L3 cohort ("Family Conflict Answer Book"), Hanyue and her team received unfavorable feedback from a Mystery-NPC expert reviewer about a "famous-quotes" feature they had emotionally invested in. In the next session, she — not the coach — proposed deleting the feature entirely and refocused the team on the

harder problem: whether the AI should give a "one-line verdict" or facilitate an actual conversation. A textbook moment of user-driven iteration at age 13, captured verbatim by Feishu Minutes and turned into a Session Review by our agent within 24 hours.

Case C · Zhuanzhuan (Online L3) — Autonomy vs. Team Focus, In Real Time

Between two sessions, Zhuanzhuan built two additional AI agents on his own (a Mulan game, an Ultraman game) — not part of the team project. In the following session review, our agent flagged that his attention had drifted from the team's main product line, but that his sense of competence was surging. The coach's next-session plan (drafted with the agent's help): a 10-minute product-decision segment forcing Zhuanzhuan to articulate his individual work in relation to the team's, and to co-decide with a teammate which product direction to ship. This is the honest complexity of online PBL that our tooling makes visible.

Case D · Luo Zhenyu Time-Friend New Year's Eve Talk 2026 (Dec 31, 2025)

MarsNavi students produced 34 short-video cover images that Luo Zhenyu used as the official visual preheat for the December 31, 2025 broadcast (45M+ online viewers, 324 global satellite venues). Luo highlighted MarsNavi by name in Section 4 of the talk ("Escaping Sameness — Education in the AI Era"), using it as a live example of "children learning AI through real, delivered work." Publicly documented in the full transcript published across Luoji Siwei, Tencent News, Huxiu, and Digitaling.

6 · What Makes This Submission Different

- **An online-PBL playbook you can actually copy.** Not a philosophy talk. A working operational system — agent prompts, session-review templates, coach protocols — that has run for two years and is willing to be inspected.
- **A non-Western operational dataset at meaningful scale.** 10M+ characters of coded classroom transcript from Chinese 8–14-year-olds. Most public AI-education discourse today draws from US/European K-12; we bring a different sample of reality.
- **A failure-first posture.** We will show the offline camps that didn't scale, the coach interventions that broke a session, and the projects that never shipped.
- **Openness to sharing.** Anonymized transcript excerpts, agent-generated session reviews, and our internal working manuscripts are available to Khan Lab School faculty and independent researchers under a simple data-use agreement. This is not a commercial pitch.

7 · About The Presenter

Rui Li spent 20 years inside China's largest K-12 education companies. As Chief Academic Officer at TAL Education (NYSE: TAL) he logged 13,000+ hours of frontline teaching and pioneered the Dual-Teacher Live-Streaming model now serving tens of millions of Chinese students. He holds a bachelor's and master's from Tsinghua University and authored a standard textbook on product thinking in China's education industry.

In August 2024 he founded MarsNavi. Since then, MarsNavi has served 100+ children, delivered 20+ real AI products, and — as of New Year's Eve 2025 — was featured by name in Luo Zhenyu's *Time-Friend New Year's Eve Talk 2026*.

8 · Whatever Role Best Serves The Summit

We have applied for a Speaker slot because we believe our two-year operational build has something specific and inspectable to contribute. But we come to the summit as students of this community, not as gatekeepers of our own material. If the four Speaker slots are already allocated, we would be equally honored to serve as a Workshop facilitator, a Poster presenter, a panelist, or a contributor in any other format that helps the program. Please treat this application as flexible in role, and firm in commitment to show up and share the work.

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Public reference: Luo Zhenyu *Time-Friend New Year's Eve Talk 2026*, Section 4 (Dec 31, 2025). Full transcript archived on Luoji Siwei official channels, Tencent News, Huxiu, and Digitaling.